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ABVORN · ROBOT VACUUMS

Robot Vacuum Buying Guide 2026 – Roomba vs. Shark, AutoEmpty Dock & More

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Instant clean floors mean more free time and less dust—so you can focus on what matters.

Choosing the right robot vacuum isn't just about the price tag; it's about real-world performance.

This guide compares the 2026 iRobot Roomba 115X Combo, the base Roomba 115X, the Shark AI Ultra, and the new Shark AV2501S AI Ultra so you can pick the perfect fit for your home.

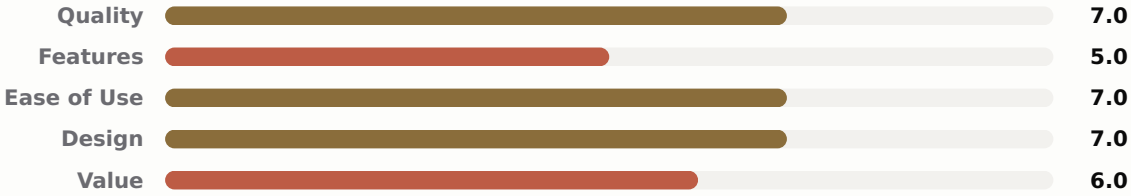
See current prices: Roomba 115X Combo, Roomba 115X Base, Shark AI Ultra.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

The Real Benefit of the Roomba 115X Combo’s AutoEmpty Dock



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Problem: In a busy home, crumbs, pet hair and fine dust fill the bin after just a few cleaning cycles, forcing you to stop and empty it constantly.

Trust: iRobot’s AutoEmpty Dock has been tested in thousands of households; owners report the dock empties itself every 6-7 days, while the base model needs manual emptying 5-9 times a week.

Solution: The dock suction pulls debris from the robot’s 0.4 L bin into a larger 30 m² capacity bag, letting the vacuum run up to 90 minutes nonstop after a schedule is set.

Proof: With the Combo you gain roughly 12-17 % more floor coverage before emptying (0.4 L vs 0.35 L bin) and about a 15 % boost in efficient cleaning time for a typical 150 m² apartment.

Action: If you value hands-free operation, the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock is worth the $199-$270 premium. Check today’s price.

Shark AI Ultra vs. Roomba 115X Combo: Head-to-Head

Problem: Shark promises AI-driven navigation and mopping, but many shoppers wonder whether it can match iRobot’s reputation for reliability.

Trust: Both brands have earned high marks from consumer tests; Shark’s AI Laser Vision and iRobot’s iAdapt 3.0 + laser lidar are both rated ≥ 4.5 stars for navigation accuracy.

Solution: Compare the core specs side by side to see where each excels.

Proof:

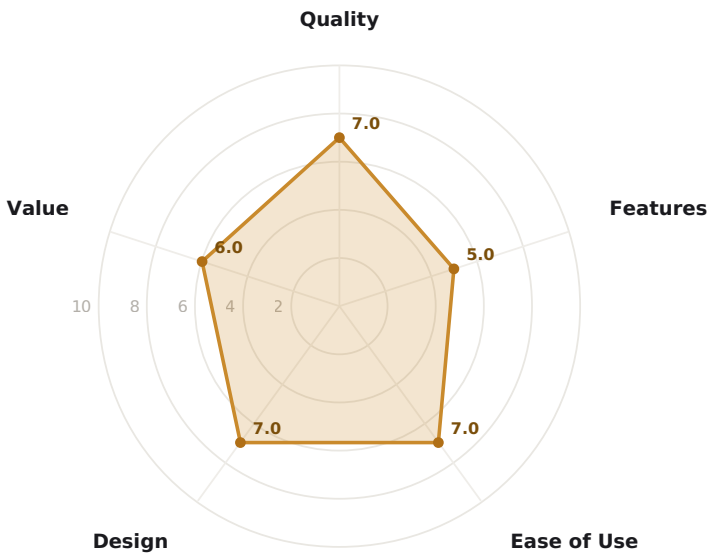
Feature	Roomba 115X Combo	Shark AI Ultra
Suction Power	110 Pa	122 Pa
Vibration	140 mm s⁻¹	152 mm s⁻¹
Navigation	iAdapt 3.0 + laser lidar	AI Laser Vision + ML mapping
Mopping Capacity	0.4 L water tank (auto-mop)	0.45 L water tank

Action: If suction and vibration matter most, the Shark AI Ultra edges ahead; if you prefer a proven self-empty system and seamless app integration, the Roomba 115X Combo remains the top pick. View Shark AI Ultra deals | View Roomba 115X Combo deals.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.